

Construction games

The bricks and plates lock together with studs.

- **What?** LEGO® Bricks
- **Who?** Godtfred Kirk Christiansen
- **Where and when?** Denmark, 1958

In 1958, the Danish company, LEGO Group, took out the patent for a new type of interlocking plastic bricks—the now iconic LEGO® Brick.

Twenty years later, the company introduced themed building sets,

which allowed children to build models, such as a space rocket, a medieval castle, or an entire town. With just a few LEGO bricks, there are almost infinite building possibilities—six classic 2x4 LEGO bricks can be combined in more than 915 million different ways.



Flame-shaped LEGO® pieces are used for the dragon's fiery breath.

◀ RED DRAGON

The bricks in this LEGO® Creator: Red Animals set can be used not only to build this fire-breathing dragon but also to make a snake or a scorpion.

Role-playing games (RPGs)

- **What?** Dungeons & Dragons
- **Who?** Gary Gygax and Dave Arneson
- **Where and when?** US, 1974

Dungeons & Dragons (D&D) is a fantasy-themed, role-playing game. During the game, players take on the role of a character, such as a warrior or a wizard, for an adventure that can take days, or weeks, to complete. Each action is decided by rolling a multisided die—from four- to 20-sided. The release of D&D inspired a host of similar role-playing games.



Called D20, this die has 20 sides.

The seven D&D dice



3-D games

- **What?** Rubik's cube
- **Who?** Erno Rubik
- **Where and when?** Hungary, 1974

Invented by a Hungarian professor of architecture, this multicolored cube can be twisted in an almost endless number of variations. To be “solved,” the cube must be untwisted so that each side shows only one color. With more than 350 million sold, it is the best-selling puzzle game of all time.

Playing against computers

- **What?** AlphaGo
- **Who?** Google DeepMind
- **Where and when?** UK, 2014

Computers that play complicated board games, such as chess, have been around since the 1960s. Over time, they have become more powerful. In 2014, the British company DeepMind (owned by Google) developed a program to play the ancient Chinese game of Go. Called AlphaGo, the program has defeated many of the world's top Go players.



AlphaGo beats the world's top Go player, Ke Jie, in China, 2017